Sai Saketh Rambhatla

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EMPLOYMENT

Member of Technical Staff, Skild AI Research, San Mateo *Dec 2025 – Present*
Research and development of Vision-Language-Action (VLA) and World Action Models (WAMs) for multi-embodiment robot control, toward generalist robot policies.

Sr. Research Scientist, Meta AI Research, Seattle *Oct 2024 – Dec 2025*
Developed techniques for native image and video generation with large language models (LLMs).

Postdoctoral Researcher, Meta AI Research, New York *Jan 2023 – Oct 2024*
Developed generative AI techniques for **generation** (Movie Gen, Emu Video, InstanceDiffusion) and **evaluation** (SelfEval).

EDUCATION

PhD in Electrical Engineering, University of Maryland, College Park *Aug 2016 – Dec 2022*
Advisors: Rama Chellappa and Abhinav Shrivastava; Thesis: Towards In-the-Wild Visual Understanding

Master's in Electrical Engineering, University of Maryland, College Park *Aug 2016 – Dec 2021*
Advisor: Rama Chellappa

Dual Degree in Electrical Engineering, Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur *Jun 2011 – Jun 2016*
Advisors: Pranab Kumar Datta and Rajeev Ranjan Sahay; Thesis: Body Pose Classification using Deep Learning

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

1. Toward Diffusible High-Dimensional Latent Spaces: A Frequency Perspective
Bolin Lai, Xudong Wang, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, James M. Rehg, Zsolt Kira, Rohit Girdhar, Ishan Misra
Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR), 2026

2. Trokens: Semantic-Aware Relational Trajectory Tokens for Few-Shot Action Recognition
Pulkit Kumar, Shuaiyi Huang, Matthew Walmer, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Abhinav Shrivastava
International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2025

3. MotiF: Making Text Count in Image Animation with Motion Focal Loss
Shijie Wang, Samaneh Azadi, Rohit Girdhar, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Chen Sun, Xi Yin
Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR), 2025

4. Diffusion Autoencoders are Scalable Image Tokenizers
Yinbo Chen, Rohit Girdhar, Xiaolong Wang, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Ishan Misra
arXiv preprint arXiv:2501.18593, 2025

5. Movie Gen: A Cast of Media Foundation Models
Meta Movie Gen team — Core contributor
arXiv preprint arXiv:2410.13720, 2024

6. Emu Video: Factorizing Text-to-Video Generation by Explicit Image Conditioning
Rohit Girdhar, Mannat Singh, Andrew Brown, Quentin Duval, Samaneh Azadi, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Mian Akbar Shah, Xi Yin, Devi Parikh, Ishan Misra
European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV), 2024

7. SelfEval: Leveraging the Discriminative Nature of Generative Models for Evaluation
Sai Saketh Rambhatla, Ishan Misra
Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR), 2024

8. InstanceDiffusion: Instance-level Control for Image Generation
Xudong Wang, Trevor Darrell, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Rohit Girdhar, Ishan Misra
Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR), 2024

9. MOST: Multiple Object Localization with Self-Supervised Transformers for Object Discovery
Sai Saketh Rambhatla, Ishan Misra, Rama Chellappa, Abhinav Shrivastava
International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2023

10. SparseDet: Improving Sparsely Annotated Object Detection with Pseudo-positive Mining
Sai Saketh Rambhatla*, Saksham Suri*, Rama Chellappa, Abhinav Shrivastava
International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2023

11. An Empirical Analysis of Boosting Neural Networks
Sai Saketh Rambhatla, Michael Jones, Rama Chellappa
International Joint Conference on Neural Networks (IJCNN), 2022

12. The Pursuit of Knowledge: Discovering and Localizing New Concepts using Dual Memory
Sai Saketh Rambhatla, Rama Chellappa, Abhinav Shrivastava
International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2021

13. Towards Discovery and Attribution of Open-world GAN Generated Images
Saksham Suri*, Sharath Girish*, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Abhinav Shrivastava
International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2021

14. Detecting Human-Object Interactions using Functional Common-Sense
Ankan Bansal, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Abhinav Shrivastava, Rama Chellappa
AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI), 2020

15. A Dual-Path Model with Adaptive Attention for Vehicle Re-Identification
Pirazh Khorramshahi, Amit Kumar, Neehar Peri, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Jun-Cheng Chen, Rama Chellappa
International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2019

16. Body Part Alignment and Temporal Attention for Video-Based Person Re-Identification
Sai Saketh Rambhatla, Michael Jones
British Machine Vision Conference (BMVC), 2019

RESEARCH INTERNSHIPS

Cruise AI, San Francisco (2022) *Advisors: Dr. Xiao Zhang, Dr. Carl Vondrick*
Developed efficient algorithms for continual self-supervised learning.

Mitsubishi Electric Research Laboratory, Boston (2018, 2019) *Advisor: Dr. Mike Jones*
Worked on video-based person re-identification and ensembles of deep neural networks.

AWARDS

- Awarded the **Ann G. Wylie Dissertation Fellowship** for the academic year 2021–22.
- Selected for the A. James Clark School of Engineering **Future Faculty Cohort** for the academic year 2021–22.
- Awarded the prestigious **George Corcoran Award** for excellence in teaching for the academic year 2017–18.
- Awarded **Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award** for the academic year 2017–18.
- Awarded **Outstanding Reviewer** for CVPR 2021 and NeurIPS 2023.
- Awarded **Best Paper Award (Honorable Mention)** at ANTS 2016, Bangalore.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewing. CVPR ('19–'26), ECCV ('20–'26), ICCV ('19–'25), ICLR ('23–'25), NeurIPS ('23–'25), ICML ('24); IJCV, T-PAMI, Pattern Recognition Letters.